

The 6:15

SATURDAY · SEPTEMBER 26, 2026

NO. 19

THE BOARD

CALENDAR (NEXT 10 DAYS) · WEEKEND, COMPRESSED

Mon–Fri Mon 9/28: Starship Flight 14 targets Starbase Pad 2, ~7:15a CDT window [NEW]. Tue 9/29: Yankees host the AL Wild Card Series opener (opponent not confirmed this run). Wed 9/30: August PCE (BEA), 8:30a ET — first inflation print since the Sept. 16 hike. Thu 10/1: Nike FQ1 FY27 earnings after the close. Fri 10/2: September jobs report (BLS), 8:30a ET.

FOMC next meets Oct. 27–28; OPEC+’s October JMMC date still unconfirmed; a large-cap cluster (Broadcom, Adobe, Oracle, Micron, Costco, Accenture, Dell, HPE) reports the week of 9/28 — dates/consensus not independently verified this run.

METRICS · FRI 9/25 CLOSE UNLESS NOTED

Oil / rates Brent \$104.37 (-2.09% d/d) vs WTI \$92.44 (-2.29%) **single tracker, not an ICE/NYMEX settle** — spread ~\$11.90, wider than Wed’s ~\$8.90. 10Y 5.17%, 2Y 4.81%, 30Y 5.49%.

FX / vol / metals DXY 101.06 (-0.23%); VIX **Thu 3:15p CDT read 15.67 — Fri close not located this run**; Gold \$4,293.06 — below Wed’s \$4,308–4,338 range and off the Sept. 20 record of \$4,415.90.

Equities / Asia / gas Dow 51,828.62 (+0.93%), S&P 500 7,743.41 (+0.51%), Nasdaq 27,068.72 (+0.5%) — a weekly gain despite the yield spike. Nikkei 66,364.20 (+1.30%), Hang Seng 24,510.09 (-1.01%), Shanghai 3,888.37; Europe closes **not verified this run**. AAA gas \$4.4918/gal, +~2¢ w/w.

Crude via a single retail tracker (flagged above), not confirmed ICE Brent/NYMEX front-month settles; rates via CNBC/Treasury snapshots; equities via exchange closes.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Diplomacy Iran’s 7-day reopening plan (Araghchi, UNGA, Thu 9/24) rejected by Trump per the Wall Street Journal (Sat 9/26); Trump reportedly told aides he expects US strikes to resume after the Nov. 3 midterms **single-**

sourced to WSJ via secondary outlets, no on-record White House confirmation.

Transits	IMF PortWatch: 1/day vs. an 85/day baseline, Sept. 20 (freshest published day; the Hormuz layer runs a 5–12 day lag). Separate tracker-based reporting put Wed. 9/23 crossings around 60 ships — a different window, not reconciled with PortWatch's.
Dark tankers	No fresher count this run continuity — carrying ~80% of a trailing two-week AIS-off window vs. ~57% of the full conflict period (peak 65.2%, May).
War-risk premia	No fresher print this run continuity — carrying 7.5%–10% of hull value (~\$21M on a \$210M VLCC).
Closures	Aramco's East-West Petroline (4M bpd, bypasses Hormuz via Yanbu) restarted Sept. 22 at a reduced rate; newer reporting narrows full restoration to 6–8 weeks, with the heaviest damage at pumping stations rather than the line itself.

Transit counts (vessels/day), dark-fleet share and hull-value premia measure different things over different windows — never netted or averaged.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Split Friday's regular-season-ending doubleheader with Baltimore (L 2-10 Gm1; W 6-3 Gm2); 92-68 by our own game-log count not reconciled against a conflicting second source this run . Locked into hosting the AL Wild Card Series opener Tue 9/29; opponent unconfirmed this run.
Knicks	No reported moves in the last 24 hours; five-game preseason slate (Oct. 5–15) made official, opening at Philadelphia.
Northwestern	Lost at No. 5 Indiana, 29-23, Friday night; falls to 2-1.

LEAD

IRAN / HORMUZ

Trump rejects Iran's seven-day plan to reopen Hormuz, tells aides to expect strikes to resume after the midterms

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi used the sidelines of the UN General Assembly on Thursday to lay out Tehran's most concrete offer yet on the Strait of Hormuz: a seven-day sequence in which Washington would lift its naval blockade of Iranian ports, waive sanctions on Iranian oil sales and observe a ceasefire extending to Lebanon, in exchange for the strait reopening to commercial shipping on the last of the seven days, followed immediately by comprehensive talks on Iran's nuclear program. [fact] The terms track closely to the 14-point memorandum of understanding the two sides signed in June and later let lapse, compressed from that deal's 60-day runway to seven days — a real acceleration if genuine. [read] Araghchi told reporters Friday that "if there is seriousness on the US side to come to a deal and reopen the Strait of Hormuz, everything is now prepared." [fact]

According to the Wall Street Journal, President Trump has rejected the offer and told aides privately that he expects a renewed US bombing campaign against Iran once the Nov. 3 midterms are past. [NEW, single-sourced to WSJ via secondary outlets — no on-record White House confirmation or denial located this run] No formal US response to Araghchi's proposal has been made public. [flag]

The mechanism worth tracing: this was the most complete diplomatic offramp on the table since the war began in February, and its rejection removes the near-term probability of a negotiated Hormuz reopening rather than the physical-workaround relief this week's oil market actually traded on — Saudi Aramco's East-West pipeline restart, not any Hormuz breakthrough, is what pushed Brent and WTI lower into Friday's close (see Board). [read] With that bilateral track now closed off, the market's own pricing of the risk — a war-risk premium still running 7.5%-10% of hull value, a dark-

fleet share still dominating the limited transits that do occur — has no reason to unwind before the midterms, and Trump's reported timeline gives it a specific window to hold through. [read] A second diplomatic track, France's US-backed push for a new UN Security Council resolution authorizing an international naval mission through the strait, continues in parallel (see Geopolitics), but multilateral naval-escort authority moves on a much slower clock than a bilateral phased deal, and Russia and China already vetoed a similar Bahrain-led draft in April. [read]

There is a domestic-politics dimension worth stating plainly rather than inferring quietly: if the Journal's account is accurate, the timing of a potential resumption of US strikes is being calibrated against the midterm election calendar rather than against conditions on the ground in the strait. [read] That sits awkwardly next to the diplomatic optics of this week's Trump-Xi summit, where both leaders discussed Iran without any stated outcome (see Politics), and against a domestic backdrop where the Fed's own hawkish repricing — a 10-year yield still at 5.17%, a hike-odds-heavy Oct. 27-28 FOMC meeting, an Aug. PCE print due Wednesday — leaves little room to absorb a fresh oil supply shock without it showing up quickly in inflation expectations. [read] For a portfolio pricing in gradually falling geopolitical risk premia into year-end, Friday's reporting is the opposite signal: the most promising exit ramp from this crisis was just closed, on a timeline tied to an election rather than a ceasefire.

POLITICS

Xi Jinping departed Washington Friday after his first US state visit in eleven years wrapped without a major new agreement beyond the

trade-truce extension to Jan. 10 that Treasury Secretary Bessent had already announced Thursday [continuity]. The concluding day produced mostly symbolic deliverables — Xi pledged two pandas for Zoo Atlanta and study invitations for 100,000 American students — while Taiwan, the Iran war and the South China Sea were discussed without any stated resolution on any of them. [fact, multi-sourced: Washington Post, CNBC, Bloomberg] Coverage across outlets converged on a "spectacle over substance" characterization of the three-day visit, contrasting the elaborate military welcome and state dinner with the thin substantive output. [read] See Technology for where the two leaders explicitly did not align.

TECHNOLOGY

Trump and Xi remained split specifically on artificial intelligence during this week's summit, according to summit coverage, with no agreement text or joint statement on AI cooperation or chip-export controls released by either side. [fact] Reporting located this run did not specify which side proposed what on export-control terms, so the substance of the disagreement — whether it concerns advanced-chip sales, model-export rules, or something else — is not verified this run. [flag] The split leaves the existing export-control regime in place unchanged for now, which is itself the operative fact for chip and AI-infrastructure names heading into next week's earnings cluster. [read]

GEOPOLITICS

France, backed by the United States, is drafting a new UN Security Council resolution to authorize an international naval mission protecting freedom of navigation through the Strait of Hormuz, following talks between President Macron and Trump at the UN General Assembly on Sept. 22. [NEW, multi-sourced: US News, Al Arabiya] It is a second attempt at Security Council action after Russia and China vetoed a similar Bahrain-led draft — which had proposed vessel escorts and demanded Iran halt attacks on shipping — in April. [fact] Separately, roughly 80 countries backed a joint statement at the UN General Assembly this week demanding the strait's urgent reopening and condemning Iranian attacks on regional shipping and states. [fact, single-sourced to one wire account located this run — flag] CNN reported, citing unnamed US intelligence sources, that Chinese groups have supplied satellite imagery and intelligence support that has measurably improved Iran's targeting of US bases and shipping in the Gulf. [flag, single-sourced, not corroborated elsewhere this run]

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the rejection reported in the Lead, two threads carry from issue No. 18 essentially unchanged: the dark-fleet share of Hormuz transits and the 7.5%-10% war-risk premium range, neither of which had a fresher print located this run. [continuity] The one concrete physical development is Aramco's Petrolina restart — newer reporting narrows the timeline to full restoration of the pipeline's 4 million bpd capacity to six to eight weeks, with officials saying the worst damage was to pumping infrastructure rather than the pipeline

itself, which sustained only limited harm. [DEVELOPING] Trump also renewed his standing rhetorical claim that the strait is "new US territory" in an overnight post, a framing he first raised in mid-August and that carries no legal effect and no new operational detail; it is noted here only because it recurred, not because it changes anything on the water. [read] Set against Tehran's seven-day framework — which would have required the US to lift its blockade, unfreeze assets and extend a ceasefire to Lebanon before the strait reopened even provisionally — Friday's reported rejection means none of this week's Hormuz counters (transits, dark-fleet share, premia) should be expected to move before the midterms pass, absent a change on the ground the diplomacy did not produce. [read]

SPORTS

Yankees	Split Friday's doubleheader with Baltimore, L 2-10 / W 6-3; 92-68 by our count.
Knicks	No moves in the last 24 hours; preseason opens Oct. 5 at Philadelphia.
Northwestern	Lost at No. 5 Indiana, 29-23; falls to 2-1.

Continuity. Weekend edition: Economics and Business are cut (nothing broke); Metrics/Calendar compressed per the weekend format. Carried without a fresh check this run: Hormuz dark-fleet share, war-risk premia, the CNN China-intelligence claim, and the AL Wild Card Series opponent. Watch for next issue: the Aug. PCE print (Wed. 9/30), any US response to Araghchi's rejected plan, and whether the Brent-WTI spread widening flagged today persists past a single tracker read.

Unverified figures are marked in red above. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.